Before digging into the most interesting part, let's quickly check out method `insert`: figure 2.21 shows there are no surprises here, the method tends to improve with larger branching factors, as does `_bubble_up`, its main helper.

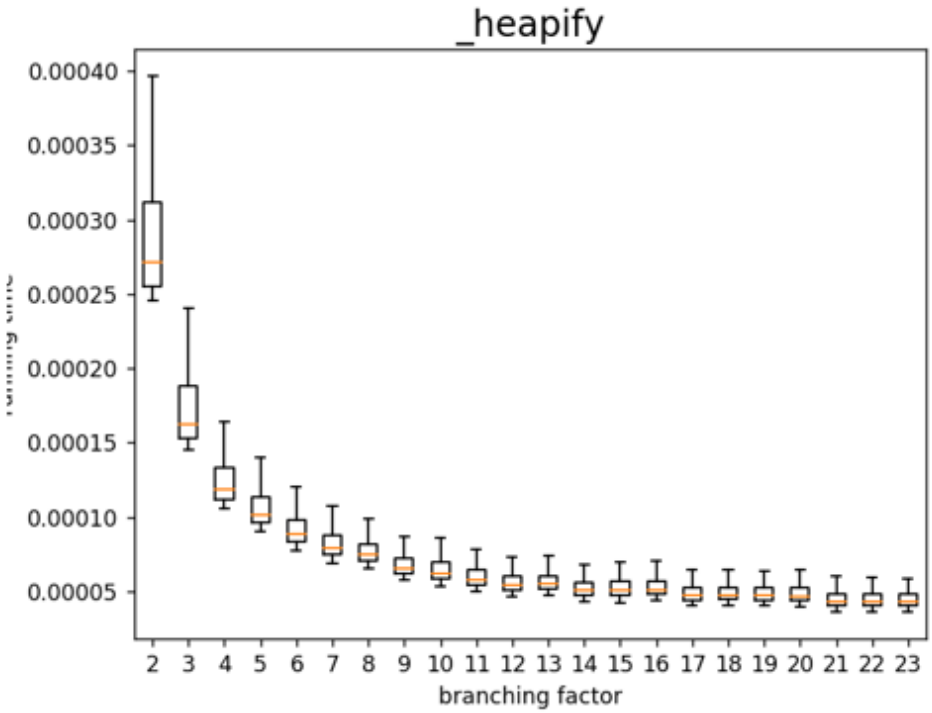


Figure 2.22 The distribution of recorded running times per-call for `heapify`.

Method `_heapify`, instead, shows a trend similar to `_frequency_table_to_heap` - as expected, since all this method does is creating a heap from the frequency table. Still, is it a bit surprising that `_heapify`'s running time doesn't degrade with larger branching factors?

Now to the juicy part: let's take a look at `top`, in figure 2.23. If we look at the running time per-call, the median and distribution clearly show a local minimum (around `D==9`), as we would have expected considering that the method's